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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT OFFERS CONDOLENCES TO MOHAMMED

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan offers his condolences to His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, on the passing of Sheikh Ahmed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, at Majlis Zabeel.

SEE ALSO P6

UAE dirham symbol joins Unicode, clearing path to phone keyboards

New digital code lets companies add the symbol to devices, apps and websites

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

The UAE dirham symbol has been added to Unicode 18.0, giving technology companies a standard way to display it across phones, computers, apps and websites.

Unicode has assigned the symbol U+20C3, a unique code that software can recognise. The change brings the dirham sign a step closer to being used in digital text alongside other currency symbols. In its September 16 announcement, the Unicode Consortium described the dirham sign as one of the release's "most anticipated new characters". The Maldivian rufiyaa and Omani rial signs were also added in the same update.

The three symbols had al-



The UAE dirham symbol

ready been approved for public use by their respective monetary authorities. Unicode said the lack of standardised codes had limited their use across digital platforms. "Vendors are now able to implement support for these symbols," the organisation said.

Need own updates

The update does not automatically add a dirham key to every phone or computer. Device makers, operating systems, font providers and app developers must add support through their own updates. Keyboard makers will also decide how users select the symbol.

A resident could therefore

see the sign in an updated app or website before it appears on their phone's keyboard. In separate guidance on currency symbols, Unicode said some older devices may never gain native support if their makers stop providing updates.

The standard code gives businesses and developers a common character to use in prices, invoices and other financial text. Until software supports it, some may continue to use an image of the sign or a font designed for their own platform.

The Central Bank of the UAE unveiled the official dirham symbol on March 27, 2025. According to Unicode's specification, its design takes the letter "D" from dirham and adds two horizontal lines inspired by the UAE flag. The lines also represent the currency's financial and monetary stability.

The Central Bank has published guidance showing how the symbol could appear on the number 6 key. Its placement on keyboards will depend on the companies that make them.

Etihad Rail Dubai station takes shape ahead of launch

Transport links, facilities almost complete

DUBAI
BY ZAINAB HUSAIN
Features Writer

With just one week to go before Etihad Rail's first Dubai-Abu Dhabi passenger service is due to launch, Al Yalays Station in Jumeirah Golf Estates is nearing its final stages, with the infrastructure around it rapidly taking shape.

New photos taken by Gulf News gives a first look at what passengers can expect when the service begins next week on September 30. While work continues around the station, several key transport links and facilities are now close to completion.

Indoor footbridge: An



indoor pedestrian bridge is almost complete, with finishing touches underway. It will connect Al Yalays Station with Jumeirah Golf Estates Metro Station on the Dubai Metro Red Line.

Dedicated road access: A separate road entrance and exit has been created specifically for the station.

Parking: Ample parking spaces are being prepared outside the station and are nearing completion.

SEE ALSO P4

TRUMP SEES IRAN DEAL WITHIN REACH AS PRESSURE BUILDS

UAE acts on Bank Melli; Hormuz strike raises tensions

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump has told Gulf and regional leaders there is "a lot of momentum" towards reaching a deal with Iran, raising hopes of a diplomatic breakthrough even as economic pressure on Tehran intensifies and another commercial vessel was struck in the Strait of Hormuz.

Trump spoke during a meeting on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly in New York attended by Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, UAE Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs; Qatar's Emir Sheikh Tamim Bin Hamad Al Thani; Saudi Foreign Minister Prince Faisal Bin Farhan; and regional leaders and officials.

UAE backs lasting peace

Sheikh Abdullah reaffirmed the UAE's support for regional and international efforts aimed at de-escalation and establishing lasting peace in a manner that enhances security, stability and prosperity for all peoples of the region.

Trump later said his envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner had held about three hours of discussions with Iranian representatives, describing the meeting as "very good" and "very productive". Another meeting was expected "in the very near future".

Iran said the contacts were conducted indirectly through

\$2.45B GAZA RECOVERY PLAN

US President Donald Trump's Board of Peace announced a \$2.45 billion Gaza recovery plan yesterday at a meeting of its members and stakeholders, in an effort meant to span over six months.

Nickolay Mladenov, the high representative for Gaza of the Board of Peace, urged for backing of its plan.

Also present at yesterday's gathering were Trump's roving envoy Steve Witkoff and son-in-law Jared Kushner. The proposal involves 66 projects, covering temporary housing and other efforts towards economic recovery.

—AFP

violations of UAE regulations and supervisory requirements, including those covering money laundering, terrorism financing and proliferation financing.

Addressing the UN yesterday, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian accused the United States and Israel of attacking his country while insisting Tehran remained open to diplomacy. "We have only defended ourselves. We are not terrorists," he said. "They did hit us, but we did not bend the knee."

Addressing Trump directly, Pezeshkian said Iran was ready for "dialogue and diplomacy and negotiations" but would not accept the "language of force".

Vessel struck in Hormuz

Meanwhile, another vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait of Hormuz yesterday, according to United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations.

The vessel caught fire and was left adrift, with its crew evacuated and two casualties reported.

Oil prices fell and stock markets steadied yesterday as investors assessed prospects for progress between Washington and Tehran.

Golan a Syrian territory

Syrian President Ahmed Al Sharaa told the UN yesterday that the Golan Heights would remain Syrian territory, rejecting any moves he said violated Syria's sovereignty and international law. "Golan will remain Syrian territories," Sharaa told world leaders in New York.

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